

Förlåt Dig Själv

*“förlåt dig själv ” is a swedish phrase meaning
“forgive yourself ”*

on understanding the fluidity
of human nature,
i question why i feel less than such.

how quickly you can go from being
something beautiful
to something destructive

nature has been cruel to you,
you. you.
i'm only saying you because

it reminds me that there once
was an us. a friendship.
something more if you look hard enough.

at what rate can
mutuality become
one sided and when did i notice

you weren't around as often.
i've seen it happen before
so forgive me if i become a little less honest.

i've learned the hard way what it means
to forgive yourself.
förlåt dig själv

a phrase i want to tattoo
across my arm
a phrase i want to remember

in a tongue that isn't even
my own.
i once saw it in a book

plastered across the front page
in all black box text
binding red as rage,

and since that moment
i knew there would be a day
when those words brought

me back to you.
& i'm sorry.

i would say it to your face

but you won't let me
won't pick up the phone
dial the number.

i know someday i'll get
over it but this was never
about me, or you

this was about them.
them. being those not
associated with us.

i warned you the day
we met i was a bomb
with a loose pin.

i warned you that
even chernobyl has never
seen the chaos i have created.

that i am the first
nuclear zone unable
to be inhabited

where death on contact
is a certainty.
people have thrived for years in chernobyl.

but, people have lost themselves
in me, & my existence
in a matter of months.

i wish you had listened.
i wish you had left before i
learned to love you so much.

now there's nothing left for me
to do. you can't forgive me.
i don't think i want you to.

i can't even forgive myself.